

Future of work, Technology and Digital Transformation



Key Areas of Common Ground

- **Digital Transformation Must Be Negotiated**

There was consensus that technology is reshaping the workplace, but must:

- Enhance transparency and efficiency.
- Protect worker rights and data.
- Strengthen consultation - not replace it.
- Be subject to scrutiny where it affects employment conditions.
- Digital governance is no longer optional; it is part of collective bargaining.

Introduction

- Technological transformation is fundamentally reshaping the nature of work, employment relationships, and labour market institutions. Digital technologies including artificial intelligence (AI), algorithmic management, automation, and digital platforms are accelerating structural changes across global labour markets.
- However, the future of work is not determined solely by technology. Its outcomes depend on policy choices, institutional design, and the strength of labour governance frameworks. A human-centred approach is increasingly recognised as necessary to ensure that technological progress enhances productivity while protecting worker dignity, rights, and well-being.



Why digital transformation matters

1. Responding to the Future of Work

Workplaces are rapidly changing due to automation, artificial intelligence, digital platforms, and data-driven decision-making. Organisations must modernise to remain effective, competitive, and responsive in this evolving environment

2. Improving Efficiency and Service Delivery

Digital systems streamline administrative processes, reduce manual tasks, and improve coordination across departments. This leads to faster decision-making, improved productivity, and better service delivery to stakeholders.

3. Strengthening Institutional Resilience

Digital capability enables organisations to operate effectively during disruptions such as pandemics, economic shocks, or environmental crises by supporting remote work, digital collaboration, and data-driven management.



Why digital transformation matters

4. Building a Future-Ready Workforce

Digital transformation requires employees to develop new skills in digital literacy, data analysis, and technology management, ensuring the workforce remains adaptable and capable in a changing labour market.

5. Enhancing Transparency and Governance

Digital platforms improve data management, monitoring, and accountability, enabling organisations to make informed decisions and maintain strong governance systems

6. Promoting Inclusive and Accessible Services

Well-designed digital systems can expand access to services, reduce barriers, and ensure broader participation by citizens, employees, and stakeholders, including persons with disabilities.



Global drivers on the Future of Work

The transformation of work is driven by three interrelated global megatrends.

1. Technological Transformation

Technological innovation is transforming labour markets through artificial intelligence, automation, digital platforms, and data-driven systems. Rather than replacing entire occupations, automation mainly changes specific tasks, requiring workers to continuously reskill and adapt. Digitalisation has also enabled new work models, including remote work, telework, and global digital collaboration.

2. Demographic and social shifts

Demographic shifts are reshaping global labour markets, including ageing populations in advanced economies, growing youth populations in developing regions, increased migration, and the expansion of the care economy. These trends place greater pressure on labour systems to create inclusive employment opportunities and strengthen sustainable social protection.

3. Climate and environmental transition

The transition to a low-carbon economy is transforming labour markets through the decline of carbon-intensive industries, the growth of green sectors, and increasing demand for new skills and job transitions.



Digitalisation and the Changing Nature of Work

Digital technologies are transforming how work is organised, enabling remote work, digital collaboration, and greater workplace flexibility. However, these changes are also reshaping employment relationships and creating new challenges for labour regulation and worker well-being.

- **Rise of Telework and Digital Connectivity**

The growth of remote work, digital communication platforms, and mobile technologies has enabled greater flexibility but also increased expectations for constant connectivity. In many workplaces, employees are expected to remain reachable beyond traditional working hours, with responsiveness to digital communication increasingly viewed as a measure of performance.

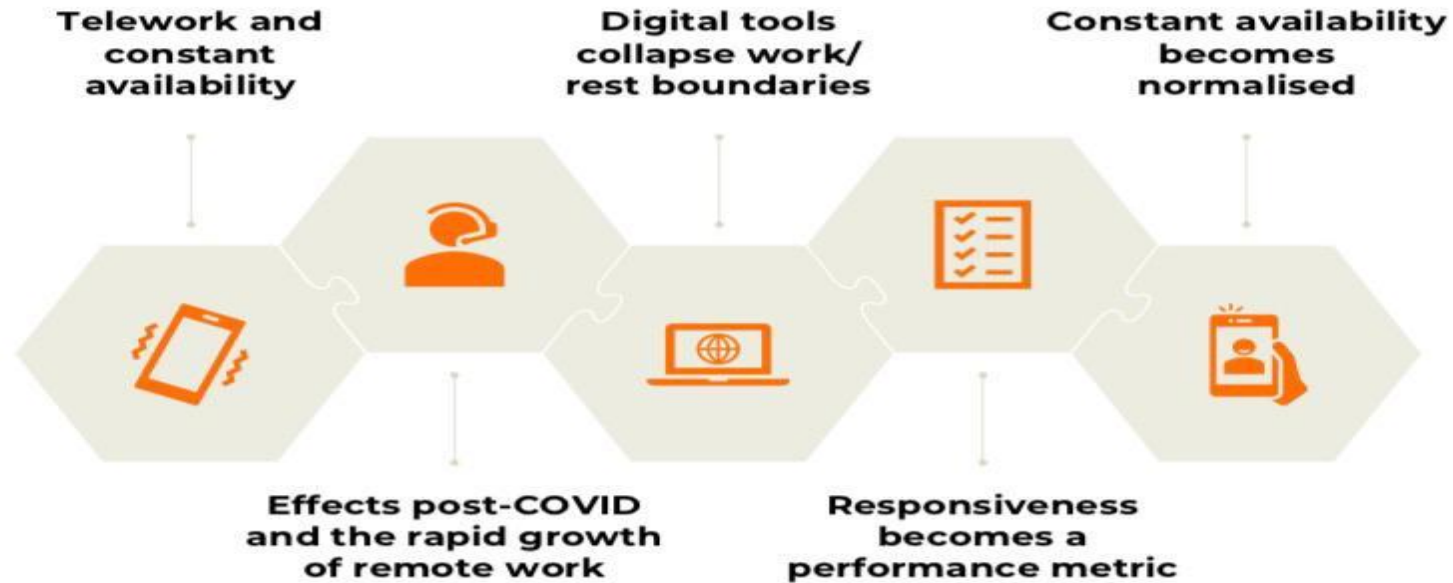
- **Collapse of Work–Life Boundaries**

Digital technologies have blurred the boundaries between work and personal life, leading to increased after-hours communication, extended working hours, and pressure to remain constantly available. Existing labour laws, designed for traditional workplaces, often struggle to regulate these new digital work environments.



Digitalisation and the Changing Nature of Work

The Problem



Human Sustainability and Well-Being

The digital transformation of work has significant implications for worker well-being.

Research highlights several emerging risks:

- Burnout and stress
- Mental health pressures
- Loss of autonomy
- Perpetual accessibility
- Increased fatigue
- These risks disproportionately affect workers with caregiving responsibilities, particularly women.
- Future labour governance must therefore address human sustainability, ensuring that productivity gains do not undermine worker health and dignity.



Key Strategic Focus Areas Include:

- Strengthen ICT Governance, Security and Resilience
- Position ICT as a Strategic Enabler of the PSCBC Mandate
- Enhance Digital Communication, Visibility and Brand Integrity
- Drive Digital Innovation and Continuous Improvement
- Strengthen Data, Analytics and Performance Measurement
- Build ICT Capacity and Institutional Sustainability



Strengthen ICT Governance, Security and Resilience

- To ensure a secure, compliant, and resilient ICT environment that protects the Council's information assets, supports business continuity, and mitigates cyber and operational risks.
- **Key focus areas:**
 - Cybersecurity and POPIA compliance
 - Disaster recovery and business continuity planning
 - Policy implementation, risk management, and governance oversight



Position ICT as a Strategic Enabler of the PSCBC Mandate

To align ICT planning, systems, and innovations directly with the Council's strategic objectives, operational needs, and service-delivery responsibilities.

Key focus areas:

- Integration of ICT with organisational strategy
- Digital enablement of collective bargaining and dispute processes
- Support for hybrid and remote working environments



Enhance Digital Communication, Visibility and Brand Integrity

To strengthen the PSCBC's public profile through coordinated digital platforms that deliver clear, consistent, and credible messaging.

Key focus areas:

- Website as the single source of truth
- Integrated social media and digital communication strategies
- Brand consistency across events, CSR, media, and digital platforms



Drive Digital Innovation and Continuous Improvement

To move beyond system maintenance toward innovation that improves efficiency, accessibility, and stakeholder experience.

Key focus areas:

- Cloud optimisation and system modernisation
- User experience enhancement and platform interactivity
- Adoption of emerging technologies aligned with 4IR principles
- Artificial intelligence



Strengthen Data, Analytics and Performance Measurement

To support evidence-based decision-making through reliable data, analytics, and reporting across ICT, communications, events, and CSR.

- **Key focus areas:**
- Website and social media analytics
- Impact measurement frameworks for events and CSR
- Improved data quality, validation, and reporting controls



Build ICT Capacity and Institutional Sustainability

To ensure that ICT capability, skills, and institutional knowledge are sustained and strengthened over time.

- **Key focus areas:**
- Skills development and change management
- Vendor and service-provider oversight
- Reducing dependency on reactive and ad-hoc interventions



Conclusion:

The future of work will be shaped not only by technological innovation but by the policy choices and institutional frameworks that govern its implementation.

Digital transformation presents significant opportunities for productivity growth and economic development. However, without appropriate governance, it risks exacerbating inequality, precarious work, and erosion of labour protections.

A human-centred governance approach, grounded in labour rights, social dialogue, and investment in human capabilities, offers the most effective pathway toward a fair and sustainable digital economy.





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